

14.1 Ripping And Burning CDs

Ripping, as the name indicates, is the process of extracting audio files from your CDs. Audio CDs are normally recorded in a “loss-less” format such as WAV. This is an exact replica of the sound as it was recorded. The ripping process compresses and encodes the songs in a “lossy” format such as MP3 where some audio information is compromised. (See chapter 2 for more on formats). CD burning is the process of writing files to a writeable CD using CD writing software. For MP3 files, the process of ripping and burning has been made somewhat simpler by media player software that enable convenient ripping and burning from within the program itself. There is some difference in the ripping and burning speeds for the free and paid versions. Popular choices for media players include Windows Media Player, iTunes, Musicmatch Jukebox, Winamp, RealPlayer and many others. Thankfully, the procedure followed is mostly similar, with a short learning curve to get used to the user interface. To show you how to rip and burn CDs, we’ve used Musicmatch Jukebox, which you can download from <http://musicmatch.com>.

14.1.1 Ripping

Insert your audio music CD into the disc drive, open Musicmatch Jukebox, and click on the “Copy from CD button”. The “Recorder” window will pop up and Musicmatch will extract all the song information for your CD as shown below.

If you are connected to the Internet, you can let the album information download from the online CD database (CDDb). If Musicmatch can’t find the information or if you aren’t connected, you can manually input the details as well.



The Recorder window populated with a song list

To verify that the encoding settings are optimum, click on Tools > Settings to open the Settings dialog